13. The Indian Ocean also contains numerous atoll formations. Examples are found in the Maldives and Chagos island groups, the Seychelles, and in the Cocos island group. A large ‘number of atolls also occur in the Lakshadweep Islands.

    Both the Andaman and Nicobar groups are part of a great island arc, formed by the above-sea extensions of submarine ridges of the Rakhine Mountains.

14.
    - Zooxanthellae live symbiotically within the coral polyp tissues and assist the coral in nutrient production through its photosynthetic activities.
    - These activities provide the coral with fixed carbon compounds for energy, enhance calcification, and mediate elemental nutrient flux.
    - The host coral polyp in return provides its zoox- anthellae with a protected environment to live within, and a steady supply of carbon dioxide for its photosynthetic processes.
15. The Sargasso Sea is a region in the gyre in the middle of the North Atlantic Ocean.
    - It is the only sea on Earth which has no coastline.

Difficulty Level: Medium

16. Continental Slope
    - The continental slope connects the continental shelf and the ocean basins.
    - It begins where the bottom of the continental shelf sharply drops off into a steep slope.
    - The gradient of the slope region varies between 2-5°.
    - The depth of the slope region varies between 200 and 3000 m.
    - The seaward edge of the continental slope loses gradient at this depth and gives rise to continental rise.
    - The continental slope boundary indicates the end of the continents.
    - Canyons and trenches are observed in this region.
17. Biomass Production and Primary Productivity